

SOME USEFUL APPS IN THE TIMES OF **COVID-19**



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The deadly Covid-19 pandemic has taken the world by surprise with the way it continues to spread like wildfire in every corner of the world. With no vaccine in sight, social distancing and stringent lockdown restrictions are the only reliable tools to battle the virus at the moment. These practices have helped to bring the virus under control to a great extent. But still, there is no surety if these can wipe out the coronavirus pandemic completely.

Weeks after lifting restric-

tions, South Korea and China have reported new cases of coronavirus infection. And Wuhan, where the virus first emerged in December, also reported new cases after the city re-opened after a 76-day lockdown. The fear of a second wave is still looming large. In India too. Both the central and state governments have been working aggressively to control the virus, from imposing a nationwide lockdown to leveraging technological support. Not only the government, private players, healthcare organisations, tech giants, etc have come with various technological solutions.

Among these several innovative and emerging technologies, mobile applications have also emerged as an effective medium to prevent the rapid spread of fast-moving coronavirus. These apps work more or less like the detective's

modus operandi—finding the infected people, their travel history, who they recently interacted with, etc.

The technique, known as contact tracing, is significantly helping to stem the coronavirus outbreak. Besides, apps help in reducing the complexity involved in the process, controlling the situation before it gets out of hand, and save considerable time. Moreover, these are useful tools for disseminating up-to-date news and verified information on the coronavirus pandemic, vaccine developments, containment zones, quarantine facilities, etc.

Mobile apps have also come forth as an effective medium to raise awareness campaigns for tackling misinformation concerning the Covid-19 crisis. This false information, ranging from the number of fatalities, medi-